

This type of a file usually has a flatter, sort of washed out look with lower contrast and sharpness, and is unsuitable for printing directly from the camera without post processing. Despite these apparent drawbacks, there are lots of areas where RAW images are the preferred choice. When you're constantly shooting fast moving situations instead of photographing still sceneries or on-set shoots, especially during journalistic shooting, RAW is almost critical because nobody can possibly shoot the perfect exposure every time with continuously varying lighting, subjects, backgrounds etc. Shooting RAW in such situations allows for quick clicks retaining enough information to fix possible exposure issues in post. Thus for shutterbugs covering weddings, events etc where a smile or a teardrop can't wait till you get to the correct settings, it's quite essential to be shooting in RAW. Also, for landscape photographers shooting nature, or rather any scene that has significant dynamic range, again in order to have added post production flexibility to burn the highlights while dodging the shadows or in any way to properly tone up the image without compromising on quality, RAW images are more beneficial.

On the other hand, say you need the images for display or have to use them immediately, you'll have to go with JPEG then. If your use will be instantly after clicking but you still want flexibility for post production effects, you may want to try the RAW + JPEG mode, so you can enjoy both benefits. Of course in that case be prepared for some extra crunch on your memory card! Identifying your need for the image will always help you decide better. Say, you plan to post the photos online, you can do this with a simple 500 pixel JPEG image on your blog instead of taking up volumes in RAW as there may not be loads left to do in post production. For most photography enthusiasts, clicking pics may well be a personal passion where you shoot moments around you to capture cherished memories forever; as such you won't necessarily require fancy tonal ranges or complex post production for every event in your personal life. It's thus better to use JPEG for these casual everyday captures. The simple rule here is that you need not be using large disk spaces or spending crazy amounts of time processing images when the differences are going to be negligible and go unnoticed.

Battery types

Usually you'll find batteries in most SLRs to be less powerful than even point and shoots. Many Pentax digital SLRs today run on four simple standard AA batteries. Variety in battery types is huge today, and common ones